

Table 5.04 How Do the US and China Divide R&D Across Sectors?

	GERD (USD BILLIONS, CURRENT PPP) ¹				CHANGE
	1994	2004	2014	2024	
United States					
Business enterprise sector	\$189B	\$278B	\$372B	\$657B	+248%
Government sector	\$40.2B	\$51.5B	\$59.1B	\$69.9B	+73.7%
Higher education sector	\$34.7B	\$57.7B	\$68.1B	\$92.7B	+167%
Private non-profit sector	\$9B	\$18.1B	\$21.7B	\$28.7B	+219%
Total	\$273B	\$405B	\$521B	\$848B	+211%
China					
Business enterprise sector	\$7.87B	\$56B	\$280B	\$667B	+8,380%
Government sector	\$7.68B	\$19.2B	\$57.2B	\$119B	+1,460%
Higher education sector	\$2.3B	\$8.56B	\$25B	\$72.5B	+3,050%
Private non-profit sector	\$0B	\$0B	\$0B	\$0B	0%
Total	\$17.8B	\$83.8B	\$362B	\$859B	+4,710%

¹ Spending levels in billions of US dollars, PPP converted, at current prices (not adjusted for inflation). Change is the relative change from the first to the last shown year. Sectors denote where R&D is performed. China reports no private non-profit R&D; it is shown as \$0, and its change cell is undefined from a zero base and appears as 0%. Totals may not sum exactly because of rounding.

Data from OECD, Main Science and Technology Indicators (GERD, PPP), OECD.Stat, 1991–2024.
Chart by Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart, Stanford University.